

SECRETARY QUICK REFERENCE LIST

Ancient Order of Free Gardeners, Inc. For Constituent & Independent Lodges

MEETING ADMINISTRATION

- Issue meeting notice **30 days** in advance
- Send reminder **7 days** before
- Prepare agenda with Worthy Master
- Distribute agenda + documents **3 days** before
- Record minutes:
 - Attendance
 - Motions & votes
 - Reports
 - Applications
 - Decisions
 - Ceremonial plans
- Archive minutes permanently

MEMBERSHIP ADMINISTRATION

- Respond to inquiries using **Interest Email Template**
- Send **Application Receipt Email** upon receiving application
- Log application into **Lodge Database**. Membership Type will be “Applicant”.
- Schedule interview/intro. call
- Place application on next meeting agenda
- Record vote in minutes
- Send **Approval Letter** if accepted
- Update **Lodge Database**; Status “Approved” or “Withdrawn” (if denied, or applicant request withdraw, or if there is no communication from applicant after 1 year).

CEREMONIAL ADMINISTRATION

- Coordinate ceremony logistics with:
 - Worthy Master
 - Instruction Master
 - Gatekeeper & Keyholder
 - Chaplain
- Prepare candidate instructions
- Complete **Admission Record** for every ceremony
- Submit Admission Record to:
 - **Grand Lodge (if applicable)**
 - **United Council (always required)**
- Archive ceremony documents permanently

- Update the **Lodge Database** to include the Date Joined (date they receive the 1st degree; this date never changes). Update the Status to “Active”. Include any significant information in the note section (date if the member withdraws, is withdrawn/suspended or expelled, or date of transfer if coming from another lodge or joining as dual member). Dual or transferring members mother lodge will be listed first then any other AOFG lodges they are a member of (your lodge will be listed last), each separated by a semi-colon (;).

REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

Annual Report

- Collect Lodge data
- Update roster & database
- Complete official Annual Report
- Obtain signatures:
 - Worthy Master
 - Secretary
- Submit Annual Report to:
 - **Grand Lodge (if applicable)**
 - **United Council (always required)**
- Archive copy permanently

Committee Reports

- Collect written reports
- Archive
- Summarize in minutes

Financial Reports

- Receive Rentmaster’s statements
- Archive
- Summarize in minutes

RECORD KEEPING

Permanent Records

- Minutes
- Admission Records
- Annual Reports
- Officer rosters
- Ceremonial documents

Long-Term Records (7 years)

- Financial statements
- Committee reports
- Correspondence

Archival Standards

- Organized
- Dated
- Labeled
- Secure
- Backed up digitally

COMMUNICATION PROTOCOLS

- Maintain Lodge email lists
- Issue reminders and updates
- Archive all official correspondence
- Communicate with:
 - Grand Lodge
 - United Council
 - Seekers
 - Other Lodges

COMPLIANCE

- Follow **AOFG Constitution & By-Laws**
- Follow Grand Lodge rulings
- Follow United Council directives
- Meet all reporting deadlines
- Maintain ceremonial accuracy
- Maintain complete archives

MONTHLY CHECKLIST

- Notices issued
- Agenda prepared
- Minutes recorded
- Reports archived
- Roster updated

CEREMONIAL CHECKLIST

- Ceremony scheduled
- Officers notified
- Regalia prepared
- **Admission Record** completed
- **Admission Record** submitted
- Ceremony documents archived

ANNUAL CHECKLIST

- **Annual Report** prepared
- **Annual Report** submitted
- **Lodge Database** updated
- Year-end records archived
- Officer roster updated